

★ Slide 1 — Hemendra Kothari

What you say:

“Today I’ll be talking about Hemendra Kothari. He’s the Chairman of DSP BlackRock Investment Managers.

Kothari fits the category of a Legacy Leader. His decisions consistently show that he wants the DSP name and heritage to continue — for example, when global firms wanted to buy out DSP, he refused because preserving the legacy mattered more to him.

His B&M score is 9,8 which shows he is high on both Concern for People and Concern for Results.

On the people side, he built strong talent pipelines, recruited from top institutions, invested in overseas training, and empowered younger employees — he believed the brightest ideas often come from the bottom.

At the same time, he’s extremely outcome-driven. He built underwriting capabilities, raised Eurobonds, expanded product lines, and took decisive action during financial scams to protect the exchange. So overall, he balances both people and performance.

In the OCEAN model, he scores high on:

- Openness — he literally invented the concept of an ‘agent’ because nothing like that existed earlier.
- Conscientiousness — he prioritised risk management and research.
- Low Neuroticism — despite meeting 42+ banks and facing rejections, he stayed calm and kept pushing.”

★ Slide 3 — Harsh Mariwala

What you say:

“Next, I’ll talk about Harsh Mariwala, the Founder and Chairman of Marico.

He represents an Entrepreneurial Leader. He began with no formal guidance and had to learn everything on his own, which shaped a very hands-on, exploratory leadership style.

His B&M score is 9,9 — indicating he is extremely high on both concern for people and results. For example, he took a bold step in promoting a non-family member because he felt the organisation’s needs should always come first. And culturally, he built Marico around how people are treated — he calls culture the biggest factor behind the company’s success.

On the hubris side:

- He openly says entrepreneurs cannot take ‘no’ for an answer — and he personally never has.
- He has strong overconfidence in his abilities, claiming he has a ‘genetic code for running a business.’
- And he has a comparative belief that Marico understood emerging markets better than others — in terms of habits, distribution, and culture.

These examples clearly demonstrate elements of leadership hubris in his journey.”

1. Machiavellianism

Strategic, calculated, and highly goal-driven behaviour.

- His refusal to accept “No” shows a strong will-to-power and persistence that can cross into strategic manipulation when needed.

Quote link: “Entrepreneurs cannot take no for an answer...”

- His decision to promote a non-family member over family indicates a cold, strategic focus on organisational advantage over emotional ties.
Quote link: “What is good for the organisation comes first.”

How to say it:

“His choices are very strategic — he prioritises organisational gain over personal or family expectations, which reflects mild Machiavellian tendencies.”

2. Narcissism

High self-belief, desire for recognition, and a belief in exceptional abilities.

- His statement “I have a genetic code for running a business” directly indicates a belief in exceptional, almost innate superiority.

Quote link: from slide 3

- His confidence that Marico understands emerging markets “better than others” shows a comparative superiority mindset.

Quote link: “We understood emerging markets better...”

How to say it:

“These quotes demonstrate strong narcissistic traits — a belief that he and his company are uniquely gifted and inherently better.”